

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A T 5 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ A 7 3

♣ J 6 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ J 6

♣ A K Q T 4



♠ K 9 6 3

♥ Q J T 7

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 8 3

♠ J 8

♥ 9 6 2

♦ K Q T 9 4

♣ 9 7 5

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

[showcards S:HA,DJ W:HQ,D2]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥Q, you played low and North won the ♥A.

North now plays the ♦J on which East plays the ♦2. What do you play now, and what is your plan.

Play the ♦3 and when North plays another ♦ win with your ♦A.

South hoped his ♦ suit would provide enough tricks to make the game. You can see that there is no entry to the South hand EXCEPT in ♦s, so you want to win your ♦A on the trick that North plays his last ♦. How can you tell which trick that is?

Only by watching what East plays. On the ♦J East played the ♦2, a low card signaling that he held an ODD number of ♦s. ODD must be either one or three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that North started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

This defense holds North to one ♦ tricks, if you had let him win the second one he would have had 9 tricks.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 8 7

♦ Q 6 5

♣ 9 7 6 4

♠ 8 7 2

♥ J 9 5 2

♦ A 8 4 3

♣ 8 3



♠ J T 4

♥ A K 3

♦ J T 9

♣ A K Q J

♠ A 6 5

♥ Q T 6 4

♦ K 7 2

♣ T 5 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

[showcards W:H4 E:S2,HJ S:SJ,ST,HA]

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥4, North plays the ♥J, won by East with ♥A.

East plays the ♠J, you follow with ♠5, dummy ♠3 and North plays the ♠2. East continues with the ♠T

Play the ♠6.

North's ♠2 tells you he had an ODD number of ♠s, obviously 3. Since East also must have 3, you must take your ♠A on the third round, depriving dummy of the extra ♠ trick.

East may now turn to the ♦ suit, but your side can win the first ♦ and drive out East's ♥K. You will win 2 ♥s, 2 ♦s and the ♠A, down 1

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ A 8 7 5 2
♦ 7 5 2
♣ 6 4 2

♠ K J 6
♥ J T 6 3
♦ A Q 6
♣ Q T 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q T 5
♥ K Q 9 4
♦ K J
♣ 8 7 3

♠ 9 7 3 2
♥ -
♦ T 9 8 4 3
♣ A K J 9

West	North	East	South
			1NT

Pass	3NT
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All Pass

3NT by South

dummy and you now discard the ♠2. West takes the ♥A and he can see that you don't want him to lead a ♠ or a ♦. He deduces that you might like a ♣ so he plays his ♣2 and you win 4 tricks.

[showcards W:H5]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥10

Play the ♦3 (or the ♠2).

You really want West to lead a ♣ if he gets into the lead. If you discard the ♣9 West will surely get the message and will lead a ♣. BUT - you will only win 3 ♣ tricks. The ♣9 would have been the fourth winner.

So instead, play a low card in one of the other suits, say the ♦3.

South is one trick short and he sees he can easily get that trick in ♥s. So he plays a second ♥ from

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q T 9 4 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ A K

♣ Q 8

♠ 6 5 3

♥ 4

♦ J 8 6 4 2

♣ J 9 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 7

♥ Q J 2

♦ Q T 3

♣ K T 7 5

♠ 8

♥ A T 9 7 6 3

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A 6 2

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

[showcards W:H4 E:HA,H3 S:H8,H5]

You are North. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥4, South takes the ♥A and returns the ♥3. You ruff and then play what???

Play a low ♣.

Partner played the ♥3, a low card, for you to ruff. That means his re-entry, if he has one, is in the lower-ranking suit.

Partner takes the ♣A and gives you a second ♥ ruff.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ T 9 4
♥ 9 5 3
♦ Q 7 2
♣ A Q J 4

♠ A

♥ A K J 8 7 2

♦ J T 5

♣ T 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 8 6 3

♥ T 6

♦ A K 8 4

♣ 8 7 2

♠ K Q 7 5 2

♥ Q 4

♦ 9 6 3

♣ K 9 6

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♥

All Pass

2 ♥ by North

East leads a ♣. Dummy plays the ♣K, you win that, cash another ♣, then cash your ♦Q. That first signal led to your side winning the first 6 tricks. Wow.

[showcards W:DA]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♦A, dummy played the ♦3

Play the ♦2.

You know partner also has the ♦K, and normally you would give an encouraging signal when you hold the Queen. But with this hand you want partner to switch to ♣s as soon as possible. So you play a low ♦.

East looks at your signal, then looks at dummy, then looks at your signal. He knows you want a switch and it looks like a switch to ♣s might work the best. North plays a low ♣ from dummy, you win the ♣J. Next you play a low ♦, taken by East with his ♦K.

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A T 3

♥ T 6

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K Q J 3 2

♠ 8

♥ Q J 8 4 3

♦ Q J T 4

♣ 8 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 7 5 2

♥ 9 5

♦ K 5

♣ A T 4

♠ 9 6 4

♥ A K 7 2

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 9 5

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

[showcards W:HA E:HQ S:H5]

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥A, North puts on the ♥Q. It's your play.

Play the ♥2.

North's ♥Q is either a singleton, (practically impossible), or a signal showing that he also holds the ♥J. In either case you can reach the North hand on the second trick by playing a low ♥. Since you don't particularly want to start playing ♦s from your side, you go ahead and play a small ♥, won by North with the ♥J.

North next plays the ♦Q and however East tries it your side will take the next two ♦ tricks and set the contract.